

DigiPick of the month

WIN!

A book by Michael Urban & Brian Tiemann on FreeBSD, just by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it.

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SAMS Teach Yourself FreeBSD in 24 Hours

By Michael Urban &
Brian Tiemann

Published by Pearson
Education

This month's
winner is Binny
Manikoth from
Kerala

A Day In The Life Of An Apple



People Who Changed Computing

Sir Tim Berners-Lee

Sir Tim Berners-Lee
invented the World Wide
Web. Period. Most
inventions are the result of



have, as a result, been banned by gyms, retailers and other companies in several countries.

The concern over their use goes even further in conservative Muslim societies, where religious authorities complain that cameras in phones are misused for such things as photographing women without their knowledge—young men in malls in the UAE have been warned by police about just this.

And in Egypt, a women-only beach on the northern coast bans cameras—and all cell phones are checked to make sure they don't have cameras. But so far, only Saudi Arabia has taken the seemingly drastic step of totally banning camera phones, and declaring them religiously forbidden.

The ban notwithstanding, the phones are still available in the country—they are smuggled in from neighbouring countries such as Bahrain and the UAE.

Sheik Abdul Aziz bin

Abdullah Al al-Sheik, Saudi Arabia's highest religious authority, announced the religious edict on September 28 in remarks to *al-Madina* daily. The devices, he said, were "spreading obscenity in Muslim society."

"All citizens should renounce this (the use of cell phones with cameras) ... for it can harm everybody without discrimination." Violators "should be strictly confronted and punished."



THE ET CONNECTION

Banned From The Net

Here's the latest on the extraterrestrial front: Reinhard Mueller, 61, an Edmonton, Canada, resident, claims he is linked to extraterrestrials. He is working to bring Earth under the United Federation of Planets, but his work has been interrupted by an order

from a Canadian judge that bans him from using the Internet.

The ban is part of his bail agreement: Mr Mueller has been charged with hate crimes. Canadian cyber-police found his site, which prosecutors claim promotes hatred against Jews. The police asked the self-proclaimed prophet a few questions about his views, and took away his hard disk as well. They say that a few writings they found were possibly illegal. Mueller denies the charges.

Mr Mueller goes by several names, including "Reni Sentana-Ries", "Grand World Councillor", "Lion of Judah", and "Guardian of the Arab Prophetess Uthrania Seila".

The Grand World Councillor's objection to his ban from using the Internet is that Net access is "a right of all citizens of earth," and that he needs it to research his defence.

According to court documents, the Lion of Judah will claim, in his defence, that there was no problem with his site until he demanded the removal of the monetary system, and insisted that people—human beings, that is—

teamwork; the WWW is the brainchild of just one person. In 1980, Berners-Lee was looking for a way to organise his notes. *Time Magazine* reports that he "devised a piece of software that could... keep track of all the random associations one comes across..."

One "hypertext" document would be sufficient to access all the documents on his computer: but what about the material on someone else's computer? He thought up a way to link others' material to his document; and he eventually thought up a way of linking documents everywhere, over the Internet. Berners-Lee then designed HTML; then URLs; then HTTP; and then the WWW's first browser. The WWW brought order to the Internet.

Sir Tim always took the academic, non-profit route. Some say if there were a category for the work Sir Tim did, he would have won a Nobel. He laments the way the Web has turned out, though—"It's not supposed to be a glorified television channel," he once said. "I thought the Web would be a tool for understanding each other."